

Jack Willis

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Office Contact Information

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Personal Information

Born: 12 March 1984
Citizenship: British, French

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Employment

Sciences Po, 2025 -
Professor, Department of Economics

Columbia University, 2017 - 2026
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics

Sciences Po, Fall 2023
Visiting Professor, Alliance Exchange Program, Department of Economics

Paris School of Economics, Fall 2017, Spring 2024
Visiting Researcher, Department of Economics

Education

Harvard University, 2011 – 2017
Ph.D. in Economics
Thesis: “Essays in Development Economics”

Paris School of Economics, Université Paris 1, 2007 - 2009
Masters in Economics (ETE-QEM)

Cambridge University, Trinity College, 2002 - 2006
Masters (Part III) and B.A. in Mathematics

Affiliations

2022 - BREAD, J-PAL
2019 - CDEP, CEPR, NBER

Publications

“Land Rental Markets: Experimental Evidence from Kenya” (with Michelle Acampora, Lorenzo Casaburi), *American Economic Review*, 2025, lead article

“Retractions: Updating from Complex Information” (with Duarte Gonçalves, Jonathan Libgober), *Review of Economic Studies*, 2025

“Converging to Convergence” (with Michael Kremer, Yang You), *NBER Macro Annual*, 2021

“Time vs. State in Insurance: Experimental Evidence from Contract Farming in Kenya” (with Lorenzo Casaburi), *American Economic Review*, 2018

Reviews / non-peer reviewed:

“Value Chain Microfinance” (with Lorenzo Casaburi), *Oxford Review of Economic Policy*, 2024

“Guns, Latrines, and Land Reform: Dynamic Pigouvian Taxation” (with Michael Kremer), *American Economic Review Papers & Proceedings*, 2016

Working papers

- “Copayments and the Value of Health Insurance: Experimental Evidence from Uganda” (with Lorenzo Casaburi and Kim Cramer)
- “Targeting Dynamic Poverty” (with Eric Teschke)
- “State Dependence and Commitment: Experimental Evidence from Crop Insurance in Uganda” (with Lorenzo Casaburi and Sili Zhang)

Selected Research in Progress

- “Frictions in Information Diffusion Among Smallholder Farmers” (with Nikhil Basavappa and Raissa Fabregas)
- “Decentralized Escrow” (with Duarte Gonçalves and Jonathan de Quidt)
- “The Impact of Contract Farming” (with Lorenzo Casaburi)
- “Mitigating Arsenic Exposure in Bangladesh” (with Prabhat Barnwal, Michael Best, Seung Min Kim, and Lex Van Geen)
- “Private vs. Public Infrastructure” (with Ben Krause and Michael Kremer)

Teaching

- 2025 - Advanced Impact Evaluation (masters), Sciences Po
- 2025 - Foundations of Development Economics (undergraduate), Sciences Po
- 2023, 25 - The Economics of Poverty (masters), IFCO 2730, Sciences Po
- 2024 – 25 Senior Seminar in Applied Micro Development (undergraduate), ECON 4911, Columbia
- 2020 – 25 Topics in Micro Development (Ph.D.), ECON 6290, Columbia
- 2018 - 25 Development Economics (undergraduate), ECON 4321, Columbia

Professional Activities

Presentations

- 2026 University of Aix-Marseille
- 2025 CSAE conference, Imperial College London, London School of Economics, Paris School of Economics, University College London, University of Delaware, World Bank DECRG
- 2024 CREST, King’s College London, Rutgers University, Sciences Po
- 2023 Cambridge University, Paris School of Economics, Sciences Po, Toulouse School of Economics
- 2022 BREAD development (co-author), CEPR / Misum / SITE development, CEPR WEFIDEV annual workshop, NOVAFRICA conference, University of Chicago, U.C. Berkeley joint development-macro
- 2021 Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, IMF research seminar, NBER / BREAD development, NBER macro annual meeting, New York University, Trinity College Dublin, Yale University, U.C. Berkeley, UK FCDO research seminar
- 2020 Columbia University, NEUDC, University of Southern California
- 2019 New York University, NYC-area junior development
- 2018 EIEF Rome Junior Applied Microeconomics Conference, CEAR/MRIC workshop, NYC-area junior development, University of Wisconsin-Madison Emerging Scholars conference
- 2017 ABCA World Bank conference, Cambridge University, Columbia University, Cornell University, CREST, DIAL conference, Early Career Behavioral Economics conference, Institute for International Economic Studies, INSEAD, Lindau meetings, NBER /

BREAD development, NBER insurance, Paris School of Economics, Princeton University, Sciences Po, Toulouse School of Economics, University College London, U.C. San Diego
 2016 NEUDC, BREAD / LEAP pre-conference, NOVAFRICA conference
 2015 CSAE conference, SAET conference
 2013 SAET conference

Referee (papers and grants):

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Microeconomics, American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, American Journal of Agricultural Economics, Econometrica, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Economic Journal, Economics of Transition, Food Policy, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Risk and Insurance, NSF, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, PEDL, PNAS, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Review of Economic Studies, 3ie

Research Grants

2024 IGC, “Improving state effectiveness in arsenic risk mitigation: experimental evidence from Bangladesh” (with Prabhat Barnwal, Michael Best, Seung Min Kim, Lex Van Geen)
 2024 Weiss, “Health Insurance Subsidies and Asymmetric Information: Experimental Evidence from Uganda” (with Lorenzo Casaburi, Kim Cramer)
 2024 Lenfest, Columbia, “Decentralized Escrow” (with Duarte Gonçalves)
 2024 STEG, “Private vs. Public Infrastructure” (with Michael Kremer)
 2023 Weiss Fund, “Decentralized Escrow” (with Duarte Gonçalves)
 2023 NBER Social Learning, “Understanding Information Diffusion in Poor and Rural Environments” (with Raissa Fabregas)
 2023 USAID DIV, “Crop Insurance at Scale” (with Lorenzo Casaburi)
 2020 USAID DIV, “Nolkup: an app to access low arsenic water in Bangladesh” (with Lex Van Geen, Prabhat Barnwal, Michael Best)
 2020 ISERP, Columbia, “Incentivizing Un(der)banked Households to Socially Distance Through Conditional Digital Loan Forgiveness.” (with Harrison Hong, Neng Wang)
 2020 NBER Social Learning, “Understanding Information Diffusion in Poor and Rural Environments” (with Raissa Fabregas)
 2019 IC2, UT Austin, “Understanding Information Diffusion in Poor and Rural Environments” (with Raissa Fabregas)
 2019 SwissRe, “Health Insurance, Impact and Price Effects: Experimental Evidence from Kenya” (with Lorenzo Casaburi)
 2018 PEDL, “The Impact of Contract Farming: Experimental Evidence from Kenya” (with Lorenzo Casaburi)
 2018 ATAI, “The Impact of Contract Farming: Experimental Evidence from Kenya” (with Lorenzo Casaburi)
 2016 ATAI, “Time vs. State in Insurance: Experimental Evidence from India” (with Lorenzo Casaburi, Bheeshm Chaudhary, Siddharth George)
 2015 Weiss Fund, “Time vs. State in Insurance: Experimental Evidence from India” (with Lorenzo Casaburi, Bheeshm Chaudhary, Siddharth George)
 2014 World Bank Big Data Innovation Challenge, “Targeting Poverty by Predicting Poverty: Using Machine Learning in Targeted Transfer Programs” (with Melissa Adelman, Sendhil Mullainathan, Paul Niehaus)
 2012 Weiss Fund, “The Causes and Effects of Improved Health Supply: Evidence from Rwanda” (with Martin Rotemberg)

Supervising

Graduate students (my role; first placement)

2026	Ricardo Pommer Muñoz (co-sponsor, TBD) Nikhil Basavappa (sponsor, TBD)
2025	Matthew Davis (letter writer; Postdoc at Oxford Nuffield) Akanksha Vardani (letter writer; Behavioral Insights Team)
2024	Dian Jiao (letter writer; Economist at Amazon) Utkarsh Kumar (letter writer; Economist at Amazon) Parijat Lal (letter writer; Postdoc at Columbia Business School)
2023	Kyle Coombs (letter writer; AP at Bates College)
2022	Kim Fe Cramer (letter writer; AP at London School of Economics) Louise Guillouet (letter writer; Economist at OECD)
2021	Ye Zhang (co-sponsor; AP at Stockholm School of Economics)
2020	Han Huynh (letter writer; Economist at Bates White) Suanna Oh (letter writer; AP at Paris School of Economics)
2019	Qiuying Qu (letter writer; Economist at Capital One)

Pre-docs (first placement)

2023	Muhammad Bashir (PhD at Berkeley Econ)
2021	Malavika Mani (PhD at Warwick Econ)
2019	Hamza Husain (PhD at Berkeley ARE)

Awards

2023	Long-term Faculty Exchange, Alliance Program, Columbia University – Sciences Po
2017	Padma Desai Dissertation Prize in Economic Science, Harvard University
2007 - 09	Paris School of Economics Scholarship
2003 - 05	Junior and Senior Scholarships, Cambridge University

Languages

English (native), French (fluent)